
Important: Energy prices from October, and what they mean for you

1 message

Octopus Energy <hello@octopus.energy>

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To: markcollinscope@gmail.com

- The Government have announced a 2 year Energy Price Guarantee, capping prices to £2,500 for a typical home
- The £400 Energy Bill Support Scheme will also go ahead with monthly payments from October to March
- This combination of a reduced cap and winter credits means, while some unit rates will rise around 30%, typical annual costs will increase less than 10%
- These discounts will be applied automatically: you don't need to do anything
- Your new unit rates will match the Energy Price Guarantee, but your Octopus standing charges will be 4% lower – so you will be saving compared to Energy Price Guarantee rates from October 1.
- We're not adjusting monthly payments yet for the new prices. We'll review your payments in the coming weeks and send you a recommendation should they need adjusting
- However from October to March your payments will be reduced by £67, as part of the Energy Bill Support Scheme
- We're working hard to help those who need it most this winter. Details below
- If you only have time for a quick rundown, head to our frequently asked questions now

Dear Mark,

I wrote a few weeks ago with an update on energy prices – here's the latest on the Government's announcement, October's prices and what it all means for you.

Raising prices is always hard. But whilst the cost of living crisis is still huge, the Energy Price Guarantee will limit this rise to less than 10% for most customers, rather than the 80% we were facing, and when combined with targeted government and company support for those who need it most (details below), will make a huge difference.

Much like the furlough scheme of 2020, it's a huge initiative being introduced quickly. There will inevitably be details which need ironing out and no doubt some flaws – but without something of this scale, winter would have been even worse for millions of people.

From October 1, your unit rates will match, and your standing charges will be 4% cheaper than the Energy Price Guarantee rates. You don't need to do anything – this will be handled automatically.

There's a personalised breakdown attached of the increase, including an outline of what prices would be without the guarantee.

We'll automatically reduce your October payment by £67 as part of the Energy Bill Support Scheme.

We constantly review your payments are set to a sensible level – we'll send you a recommendation over the coming weeks should they need adjustment due to the new prices. Of course, you're always in control, and can change your payments at any time in your online account.

I know, despite Government help, this winter will still be tough for many. We will continue to do everything we can to help our customers through the crisis.

Cheaper, greener energy is why Octopus exists. We've always set our prices below Ofgem's price cap – we're

doing that again now, and we intend to keep doing so in future.

The Government's Energy Price Guarantee is helping lower unit rates, but standing charges are still astronomical. 6 months ago, we introduced Loyal Octopus support to help address this, but today Loyal Octopus support is changing to direct support where it's needed most.

We're reducing your standing charges a further 4% from the Government discounted level – I wish it could be more, but in times like these it's only right to direct as much help as possible to those less fortunate. We've also stopped advertising on TV, bus stops, train stations, sports arenas and online, and are redirecting all these funds to help customers who are struggling.

We'll use these funds to provide a standing charge holiday for up to 100,000 customers, for up to 6 months, depending on need. We'll share more about this new program soon.

This ensures if you need support, you will get more of it.

We're also introducing our Energy Helpers service who will visit up to 500,000 customer homes this winter to give personalised energy efficiency advice.

If you are having difficulty paying, make sure you're getting the support you're entitled to. This blog post outlines all the help available from the Government, Octopus, and others, plus how to access it.

You're always welcome to contact us, but we will be busy - very busy. We don't use error-prone "voice recognition", endless "push button" menu systems or frustrating chatbots. Whether you email or call, you'll deal with real people who're here to help - and experiencing the same difficulties as everyone else.

We'll always offer the best fixed prices we can to our existing customers, but in the current market, those prices are well above the new capped price. With this in mind, we're not currently offering standard fixed term tariffs – they simply don't make much sense right now.

Yours sincerely,
Greg Jackson
Founder, Octopus Energy

PS. In the current environment, it's important you get the support you're entitled to. We've put together this blog post which outlines all the help available and how to get it.
